Kevan Maxwell Davis

Staff Software Engineer | Product Engineering, AI & Commerce

Denver, Colorado, USA | i.am.kevan.davis@gmail.com | 817-791-3542 | linkedin.com/in/kevanmdavis

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff Software Engineer with 20 years of experience delivering commerce products, developer platforms, and AI-assisted workflows. Brings product judgment to ambiguous, cross-system problems: prototypes and evaluates feasible solutions, builds pragmatic abstractions, and collaborates across teams to carry them toward launch. Deep TypeScript/React experience, hands-on generative AI engineering, and a track record of technical leadership and mentorship at Shopify.

CORE SKILLS

Product and engineering: Technical leadership, end-to-end product development, TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Node.js, API architecture, checkout and messaging workflows, developer experience, Ruby on Rails, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Prisma

Applied AI: Vercel AI SDK, OpenAI, Anthropic, Gemini, agent orchestration, model evaluation, multimodal generation, MCP, human-in-the-loop validation, provider fallbacks

Platform and operations: Docker, Kubernetes, asynchronous jobs, reliability patterns, cross-functional implementation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Shopify | Staff Software Engineer | 2021–2026

- Identified a barrier to launching bundled-product functionality for **500,000+ merchants** who had customized at least one Shopify email template. Independently designed and iterated on an agent-based Liquid migration prototype, achieving **90% success on a small curated benchmark** and enabling a production-development initiative.
- Established a staged migration evaluation process: parse validation, before/after renders compared with vision models to check preservation of customizations and new functionality, and human review. Served as **technical lead for six engineers** during production development; the initiative was canceled before launch.
- Contributed across Shopify Bundles' merchant experience, checkout behavior, and first-party Admin application. Brought Shopify's UI extension pattern into the Admin product detail page and built the initial Bundles card; mentored junior developers and an intern.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

- Re-architected **Shopp-E**, Shopify's internal AI media product first started by another person, into a reusable TypeScript library with web, CLI, and MCP clients, serving an estimated hundreds of daily users and generating **100,000+ images**. Designed model-capability metadata, asynchronous generation, provider failover, and video job polling.
- Built multi-agent developer productivity tools including specialized code review, summary/diagram generation, low-latency safety checks with human override, and extensible UI components for Pi IDE.
- Implemented coverage calculations and rule-inheritance visualizations for channel-specific merchant product data, in a product shipped as part of Shopify Editions in 2026; prototyped enhancements to the bulk editor.

Shopify | Senior Software Engineer | 2019–2021

- Co-designed and prototyped developer-facing APIs for sandboxed Checkout UI Extensions with a Principal Engineer. The underlying concepts carried forward into Shopify's production checkout extensibility platform.
- Worked on native B2B commerce capabilities including business customers and deferred payment terms following Shopify's acquisition of Handshake.
- Contributed to a first-party post-checkout upsell product; named co-inventor on U.S. Patent 11,403,658, *Systems and methods for providing post-transaction offers* (2022).

Handshake (acquired by Shopify) | Senior Developer / Engineer | October 2014–May 2019

- Worked across a small engineering organization on a multi-tenant wholesale commerce platform; contributed to the React replatforming, self-service ordering, and configurable B2B catalogs.

Gilt Groupe | Web Developer → Senior Web Developer | April 2009–August 2014

- Developed major ecommerce checkout and cart experiences, shared frontend libraries, build and asset tooling, and responsive UI; mentored other engineers.

Earlier: Mindspark Interactive Networks, Web Developer (2008–2009); Tyler Technologies, Developer (2006–2008); UTA AI Lab, Research Assistant (through 2006).

EDUCATION

University of Texas at Arlington | B.S., Computer Science